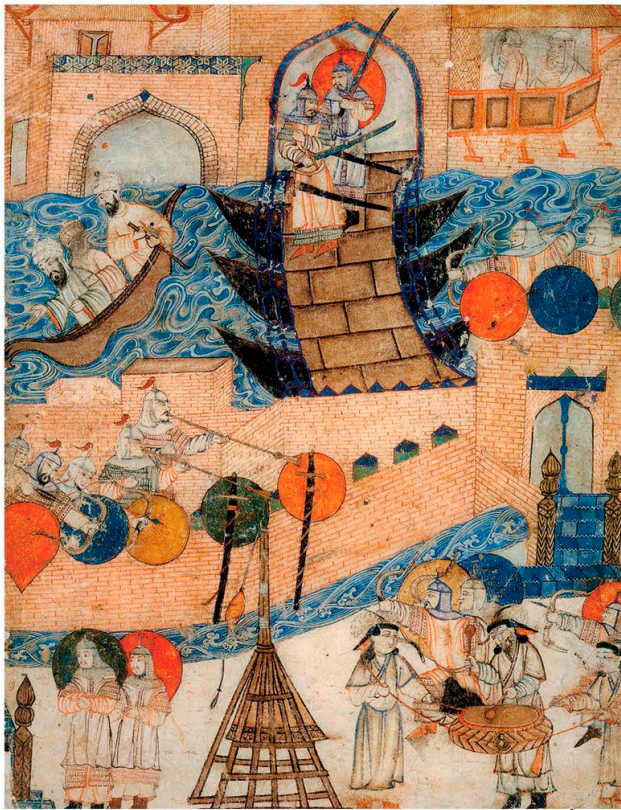


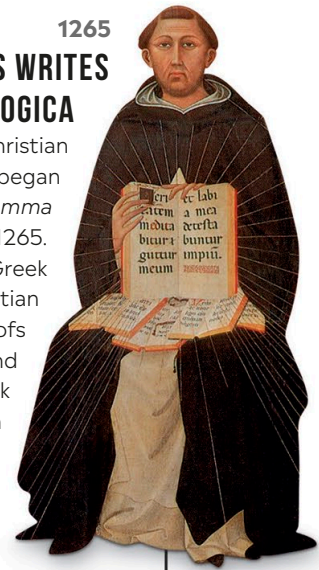


△ Mongol siege of Baghdad, 14th-century Persian painting

1265 THOMAS AQUINAS WRITES SUMMA THEOLOGICA

The foremost medieval Christian thinker, Thomas Aquinas began writing his masterwork, *Summa Theologica*, in Rome in 1265. Reconciling Ancient Greek philosophy with the Christian faith, he offered rational proofs of the soul's immortality and the existence of God. His work laid the basis for modern Western philosophy.

▷ *St Thomas Aquinas*, Francesco Traini, 1363



1269

1250 In the Seventh Crusade, French King Louis IX is captured by Muslims in Egypt

1260 The Mamluk ruler Baibars defeats the Mongols invading Palestine at Ain Jalut

1260 Kublai Khan becomes Khagan (Great Khan), the supreme ruler of the Mongol Empire

1250 MAMLUKS RULE EGYPT

The Mamluks were a warrior class of slave soldiers who served the various dynasties of sultans ruling Egypt. After defeating a Crusader invasion of Egypt in 1250, Mamluk generals seized power in Cairo, overthrowing the Ayyubid dynasty. The Mamluks went on to rule Egypt for almost three centuries.



△ Mamluk horsemen



1215-1294 KUBLAI KHAN

Kublai was a grandson of Chinggis Khan. As Mongol Great Khan from 1260, he conquered China, founding the Yuan dynasty in 1271. Ruling from Beijing, he campaigned as far afield as Japan and Java.